

An illustration of proportional hazards, additive hazards and accelerated failure time models

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Preliminaries

This document serves as the Supplementary Material of the paper “Alternatives to the Cox proportional hazards model: A review of additive hazards and accelerated failure time models”, (to be) published in Statistica Neerlandica. Section 5.2 of that paper contains a data example, of which this document shows the full R code.

We will be using the pbc data from the survival package, in a very much simplified setting. The aim of this illustration is to highlight differences in assumptions between different models, and to illustrate techniques that attempt to alleviate restrictions in the original models. We therefore restrict to only two covariates, hepato and edema, out of many in the pbc data that significantly influence survival. Of these two, edema violates the PH assumption.

```
# Suppresses all warnings for the rest of this script (not just  
# the package-loading messages below) - convenient here since  
# several packages used produce noisy convergence/deprecation  
# warnings, but it also hides any other warning that might occur.  
options(warn = -1)
```

```

# Loading packages
suppressPackageStartupMessages({
  library(tictoc) # used for computation time
  library(survival)
  library(ggplot2) # used for all survival-curve plots
  library(patchwork) # used for the combined figure at the end
  # Packages for additive hazards models, in addition to survival
  library(ahMLE)
  library(timereg)
  library(aftgee)
  # Packages for AFT models, in addition to survival
  library(lss2)
  library(rms)
  library(aftsem)
  library(flexsurv)
  library(eha)
})

# head(pbc) # look at help(pbc) for more information on the data
table(pbc$hepato, useNA = "always")

```

```

##
##      0      1 <NA>
## 152  160  106

```

One of the two variables of interest, `hepato`, is only used in the original 312 patients included in the RCT (see `help(pbc)` for context). For the purpose of this illustration we restrict to this subset. We are going to overwrite `pbc` (the original `pbc` data will remain available in the `survival` package).

```

pbc <- subset(pbc, !is.na(hepato))
# Looking at events
table(pbc$status) # 0=censored, 1=transplant, 2=dead

```

```

##
##      0      1      2
## 168  19 125

```

```

pbc$stat <- pbc$status
pbc$stat[pbc$stat == 2] <- 1 # so we use transplant-free survival
table(pbc$stat)

```

```

##
##      0      1
## 168 144

```

```
table(pbc$edema)
```

```
##  
##    0 0.5    1  
## 263  29   20
```

We are also going to overwrite edema with a binary version where the value 0.5 is set to 1 (so 0.5 and 1 are combined into one group). (Again, the original data will remain available in the survival package.)

```
pbc$edema[pbc$edema == 0.5] <- 1
```

In what follows we are going to construct model-based survival curves for each of the four combinations of hepato and edema. These are the numbers for these combinations.

```
table(pbc$hepato, pbc$edema)
```

```
##  
##      0    1  
##  0 138   14  
##  1 125   35
```

```
# We prefer to work with time in years
```

```
year <- 365.25
```

```
pbc$yrs <- pbc$time / year
```

```
# Helper for the four-group (hepato x edema) survival curve plots  
# used throughout this script in place of base R plot()/lines()/  
# legend(). type = "step" for Kaplan-Meier-type/model-based  
# curves defined by jumps at event times; type = "line" for  
# smooth parametric curves evaluated on a dense time grid. No  
# confidence bands or numbers-at-risk are shown, per the level of  
# detail used in the original base R plots. combine_he() and  
# plot_he_survival() below both rely on the global constants  
# he_levels and he_pal defined here.
```

```
he_levels <- c("No / no", "No / yes", "Yes / no", "Yes / yes")
```

```
# matches base R col = 1:4
```

```
he_pal <- c("black", "red", "green3", "blue")
```

```
# Combines the four per-group (hepato x edema) data frames - each  
# with columns time and surv - into one long data frame with a  
# group column, ready for plot_he_survival().
```

```
combine_he <- function(d00, d01, d10, d11) {
```

```
  d00$group <- he_levels[1]
```

```
  d01$group <- he_levels[2]
```

```
  d10$group <- he_levels[3]
```

```
  d11$group <- he_levels[4]
```

```

out <- rbind(d00, d01, d10, d11)
out$group <- factor(out$group, levels = he_levels)
out
}

plot_he_survival <- function(
  df, title, type = c("step", "line")
) {
  type <- match.arg(type)
  geom_fun <- if (type == "step") geom_step else geom_line
  ggplot(df, aes(x = time, y = surv, color = group)) +
    geom_fun(linewidth = 0.8) +
    scale_color_manual(values = he_pal, breaks = he_levels) +
    # coord_cartesian() (rather than ylim()/scale limits) zooms
    # the view to [0, 1] without dropping or warning about data
    # points outside that range - needed because one of the
    # additive hazards curves later on goes slightly above 1.
    coord_cartesian(ylim = c(0, 1)) +
    labs(
      x = "Years",
      y = "Survival",
      color = "Hepato / edema",
      title = title
    ) +
    theme_minimal(base_size = 12) +
    theme(legend.position = "bottom")
}

```

We start with separate Kaplan-Meier survival curves for the four different combinations no/yes of hepato and edema.

```

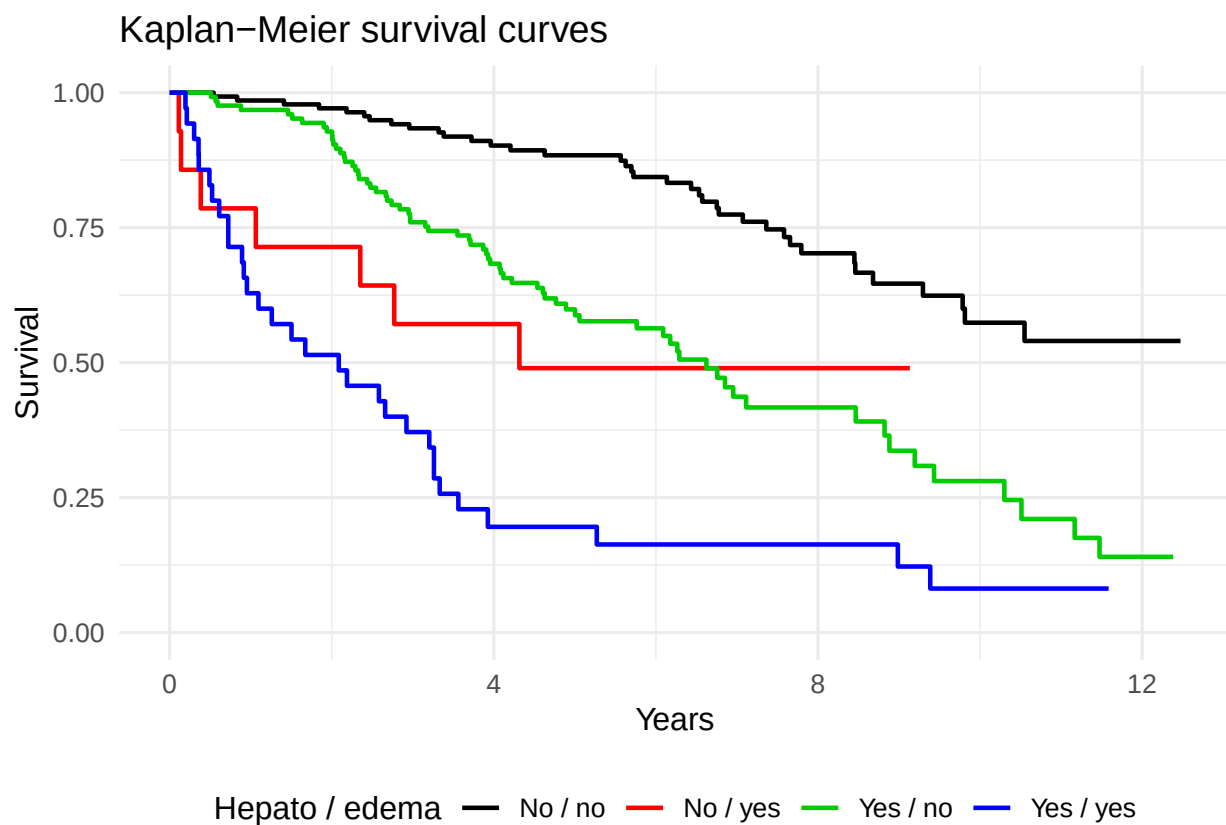
pbc$he <- 2 * pbc$hepato + pbc$edema
pbc$he <- factor(
  pbc$he, levels = 0:3,
  labels = c("No / no", "No / yes", "Yes / no", "Yes / yes")
)
sfhe <- survfit(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ he, data = pbc)
# pdf("Kaplan_Meiers.pdf")
kmdf <- data.frame(
  time = sfhe$time,
  surv = sfhe$surv,
  group = rep(sub("^he=", "", names(sfhe$strata)), sfhe$strata)
)
kmdf$group <- factor(kmdf$group, levels = he_levels)
# plot.survfit() implicitly starts every curve at (0, 1); add

```

```

# that starting point explicitly since we are bypassing
# plot.survfit().
kmdf <- rbind(
  data.frame(time = 0, surv = 1,
             group = factor(he_levels, levels = he_levels)),
  kmdf
)
# pdf("Kaplan-Meiers.pdf")
plot_he_survival(
  kmdf, "Kaplan-Meier survival curves", type = "step"
)

```



```

# dev.off()

```

Proportional hazards models

We start by fitting a Cox proportional hazards model with the two variables of interest.

```

c1 <- coxph(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
summary(c1) # both highly significant

```

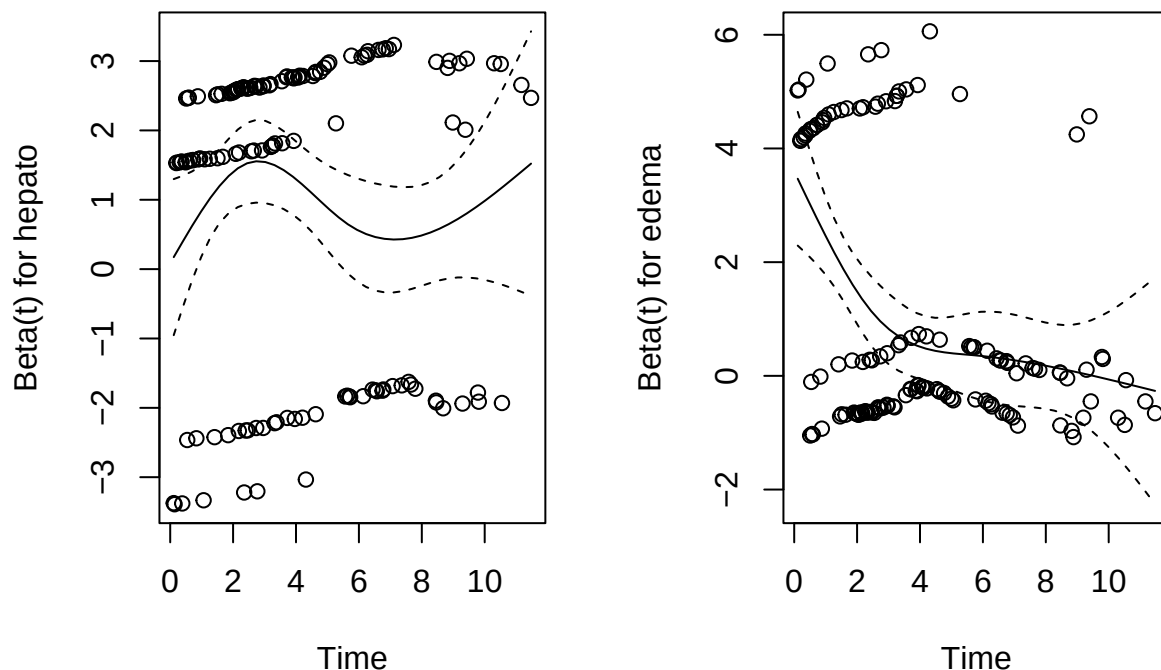
```
## Call:
## coxph(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
##
##      n= 312, number of events= 144
##
##              coef exp(coef) se(coef)      z Pr(>|z|)
## hepato  1.0120     2.7511   0.1851  5.466 4.59e-08 ***
## edema   1.0591     2.8838   0.1936  5.471 4.48e-08 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
##              exp(coef) exp(-coef) lower .95 upper .95
## hepato     2.751      0.3635     1.914     3.955
## edema      2.884      0.3468     1.973     4.214
##
## Concordance= 0.71 (se = 0.021 )
## Likelihood ratio test= 68.61  on 2 df,   p=1e-15
## Wald test               = 72.7  on 2 df,   p=<2e-16
## Score (logrank) test = 83.6  on 2 df,   p=<2e-16
```

```
cz1 <- cox.zph(c1)
cz1 # edema violates PH
```

```
##              chisq df      p
## hepato   1.42  1    0.23
## edema   18.42  1 1.8e-05
## GLOBAL  18.43  2 1.0e-04
```

From the output of `cz1` we see that `edema` violates the proportional hazards (PH) assumption. The time-dependent behaviour $\beta(t)$ can be plotted, from which we can learn how the estimated regression coefficients varies with time. I am using `transform = "identity"` here to make sure that in the plot we see time linearly. The default is to plot $\beta(t)$ with time transformed, which makes it more difficult (in my view) to interpret $\beta(t)$.

```
par(mfrow = c(1, 2))
plot(cox.zph(c1, transform = "identity"))
```



```
par(mfrow = c(1, 1))
```

The $\beta(t)$ for **hepato** seems to go up and down somewhat, but one could imagine a straight line reasonably within the 95% pointwise confidence intervals, compatible with a time-constant β . The $\beta(t)$ for **edema** is quite different. The estimated β is huge, about 4 (this is the *log* hazard ratio!), and quickly decreases to 0 after about 5 years.

The easiest way to deal with the violation of the PH assumption for edema is to fit a stratified Cox model, where separate baseline hazards are estimated for edema no and edema yes, and a hazard ratio (HR) for hepato (assumed to be the same for edema no and edema yes).

```
# Stratified Cox model, stratified according to edema
c2 <- coxph(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + strata(edema), data = pbc)
summary(c2)
```

```
## Call:
## coxph(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + strata(edema), data = pbc)
##
##      n= 312, number of events= 144
##
##              coef exp(coef) se(coef)      z Pr(>|z|)
## hepato  1.0538    2.8684    0.1867  5.643 1.67e-08 ***
## ---
```

```
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
##          exp(coef) exp(-coef) lower .95 upper .95
## hepato    2.868      0.3486    1.989    4.136
##
## Concordance= 0.638 (se = 0.023 )
## Likelihood ratio test= 34.56  on 1 df,   p=4e-09
## Wald test            = 31.84  on 1 df,   p=2e-08
## Score (logrank) test = 34.35  on 1 df,   p=5e-09
```

```
cox.zph(c2) # PH not violated for hepato
```

```
##          chisq df    p
## hepato 0.0215  1 0.88
## GLOBAL 0.0215  1 0.88
```

The PH assumption is not violated for hepato, so at least with respect to the PH assumption this seems to be a reasonable model. The model does not have an estimated hazard ratio / regression coefficient for edema. The reason is that the PH assumption for edema (which would give a HR) is replaced by two separate baseline hazards (so no HR). If a numeric description of the effect of edema is required, one would have to model $\beta(t)$ by replacing the stratification by an interaction of edema with a pre-specified function of time. The plot of `cox.zph` above could inform which function to use. Judging by this plot, something like $f(t) = \log(t + 1)$ could work well.

We will continue to show survival curves for four patients, namely for all four combinations of hepato 0/1, and edema 0/1.

```
# According to Cox model, and stratified Cox model
# First Cox model
nd00 <- data.frame(hepato = 0, edema = 0)
nd01 <- data.frame(hepato = 0, edema = 1)
nd10 <- data.frame(hepato = 1, edema = 0)
nd11 <- data.frame(hepato = 1, edema = 1)

sf00 <- survfit(c1, newdata = nd00)
sf00 <- data.frame(time = sf00$time, surv = sf00$surv)
sf00 <- rbind(data.frame(time = 0, surv = 1), sf00)
sf00 <- subset(sf00, !duplicated(surv))
sf01 <- survfit(c1, newdata = nd01)
sf01 <- data.frame(time = sf01$time, surv = sf01$surv)
sf01 <- rbind(data.frame(time = 0, surv = 1), sf01)
sf01 <- subset(sf01, !duplicated(surv))
sf10 <- survfit(c1, newdata = nd10)
sf10 <- data.frame(time = sf10$time, surv = sf10$surv)
sf10 <- rbind(data.frame(time = 0, surv = 1), sf10)
sf10 <- subset(sf10, !duplicated(surv))
```

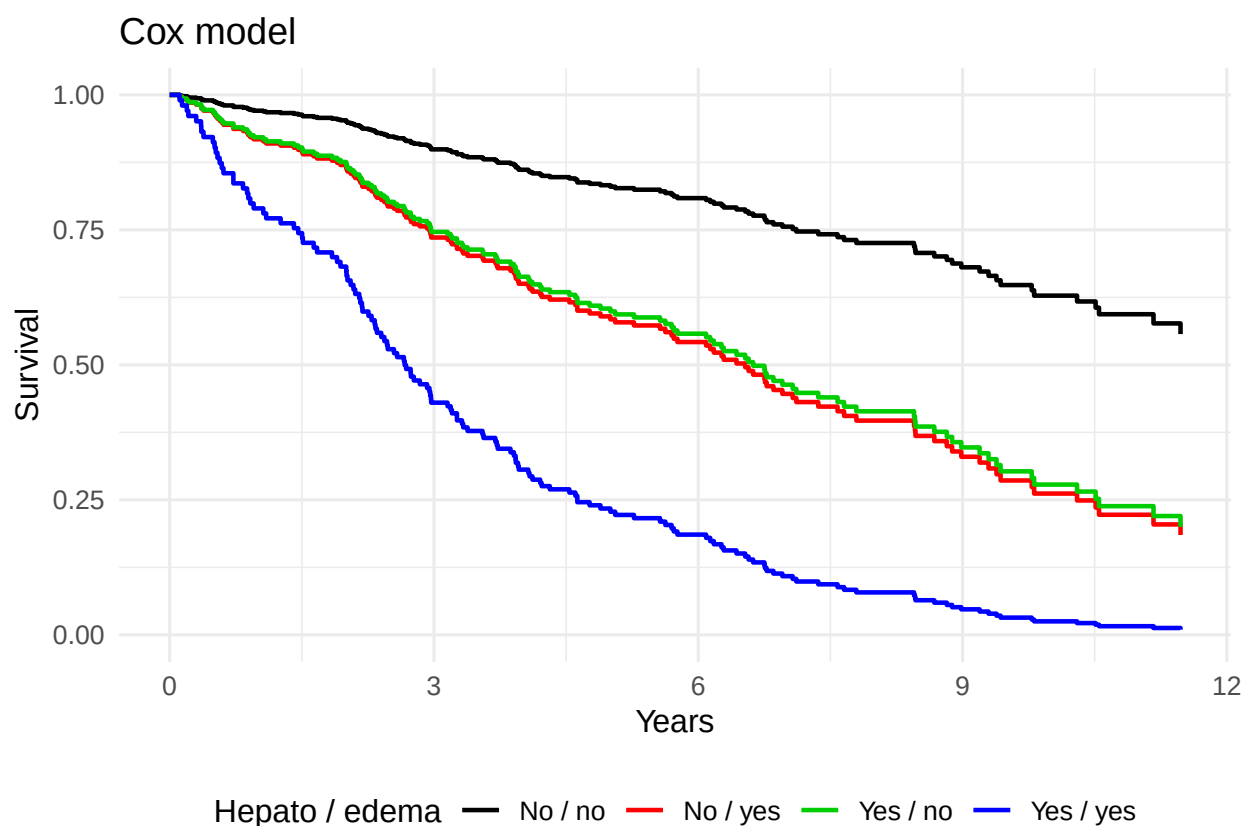


```

sf11 <- survfit(c1, newdata = nd11)
sf11 <- data.frame(time = sf11$time, surv = sf11$surv)
sf11 <- rbind(data.frame(time = 0, surv = 1), sf11)
sf11 <- subset(sf11, !duplicated(surv))

# pdf("Cox_model.pdf")
df_cox <- combine_he(sf00, sf01, sf10, sf11)
p_cox <- plot_he_survival(df_cox, "Cox model", type = "step")
p_cox

```



```

# dev.off()

sf00_cox <- sf00
sf01_cox <- sf01
sf10_cox <- sf10
sf11_cox <- sf11

# Then stratified Cox model
sf00 <- survfit(c2, newdata = nd00)
sf00 <- data.frame(time = sf00$time, surv = sf00$surv)
sf00 <- rbind(data.frame(time = 0, surv = 1), sf00)

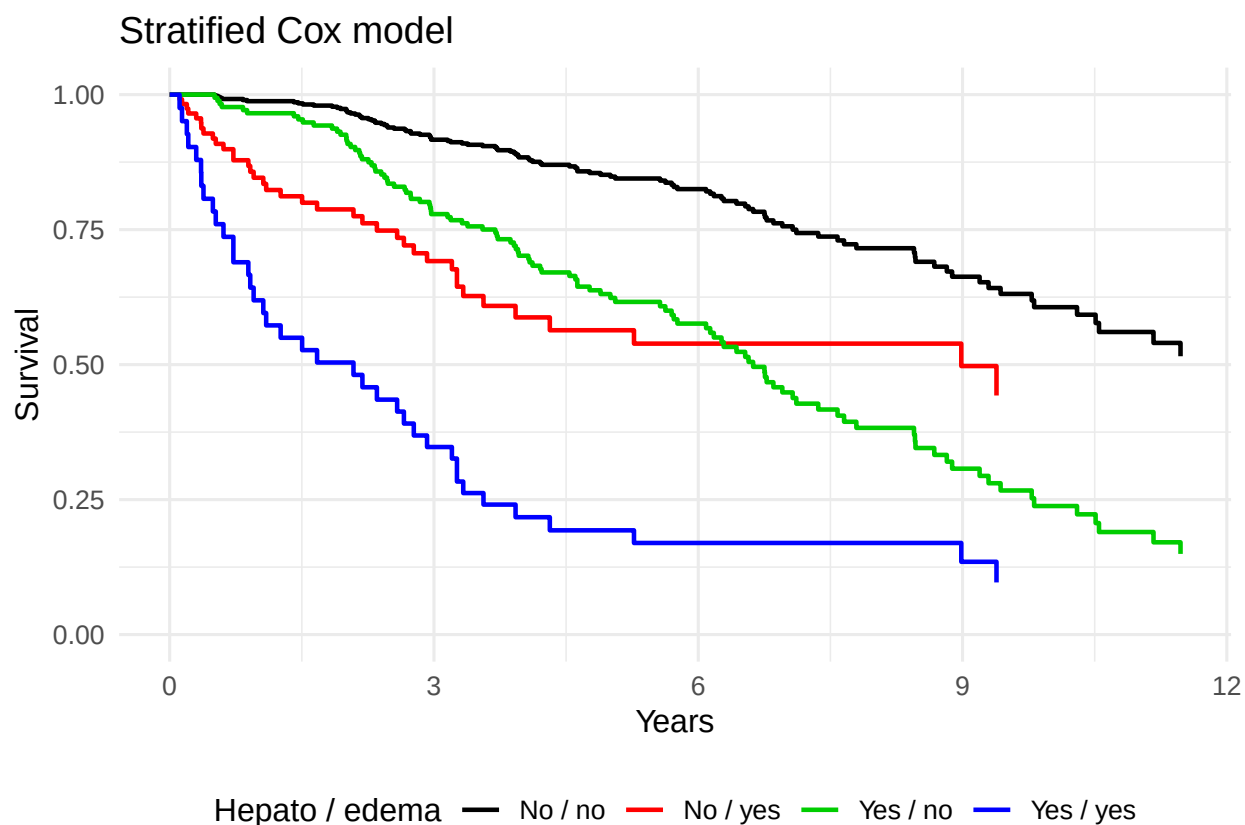
```

```

sf00 <- subset(sf00, !duplicated(surv))
sf01 <- survfit(c2, newdata = nd01)
sf01 <- data.frame(time = sf01$time, surv = sf01$surv)
sf01 <- rbind(data.frame(time = 0, surv = 1), sf01)
sf01 <- subset(sf01, !duplicated(surv))
sf10 <- survfit(c2, newdata = nd10)
sf10 <- data.frame(time = sf10$time, surv = sf10$surv)
sf10 <- rbind(data.frame(time = 0, surv = 1), sf10)
sf10 <- subset(sf10, !duplicated(surv))
sf11 <- survfit(c2, newdata = nd11)
sf11 <- data.frame(time = sf11$time, surv = sf11$surv)
sf11 <- rbind(data.frame(time = 0, surv = 1), sf11)
sf11 <- subset(sf11, !duplicated(surv))

# pdf("Stratified_Cox_model.pdf")
df_scox <- combine_he(sf00, sf01, sf10, sf11)
p_scox <- plot_he_survival(
  df_scox, "Stratified Cox model", type = "step"
)
p_scox

```



```
# dev.off()
```

Additive hazards models

We continue to fit additive hazards models. The non-parametric OLS has been implemented for instance in the survival package, function `aareg()`, and in the timereg package, using `aalen()`. We will first illustrate `aareg()` from survival.

```
a0 <- aareg(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
head(a0$coef) # Estimated beta's
```

```
##               Intercept      hepato      edema
## 0.112251882272416 0.004491233 -0.009449554 0.02266661
## 0.139630390143737 0.004616610 -0.009713348 0.02329937
## 0.194387405886379 -0.001628293 0.003425929 0.02035367
## 0.210814510609172 -0.001665179 0.003503537 0.02081474
## 0.301163586584531 -0.001703775 0.003584742 0.02129719
## 0.355920602327173 -0.001744202 0.003669802 0.02180253
```

```
head(apply(a0$coef, 2, cumsum)) # Estimated cumulative beta's
```

```
##               Intercept      hepato      edema
## 0.112251882272416 0.004491233 -0.009449554 0.02266661
## 0.139630390143737 0.009107843 -0.019162903 0.04596598
## 0.194387405886379 0.007479550 -0.015736974 0.06631965
## 0.210814510609172 0.005814371 -0.012233437 0.08713439
## 0.301163586584531 0.004110596 -0.008648694 0.10843157
## 0.355920602327173 0.002366394 -0.004978893 0.13023410
```

```
# plot(a0)
```

The function `aalen()` from the timereg package gives exactly the same estimates as `aareg()` from survival, but in addition useful tests for $\beta(t) = 0$ and for $\beta(t)$ being time-constant are also provided (for the latter null hypothesis both a Kolmogorov-Smirnov and a Cramer-von Mises test).

```
a1 <- aalen(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
head(a1$cum) # same as the cumsum of a0$coef
```

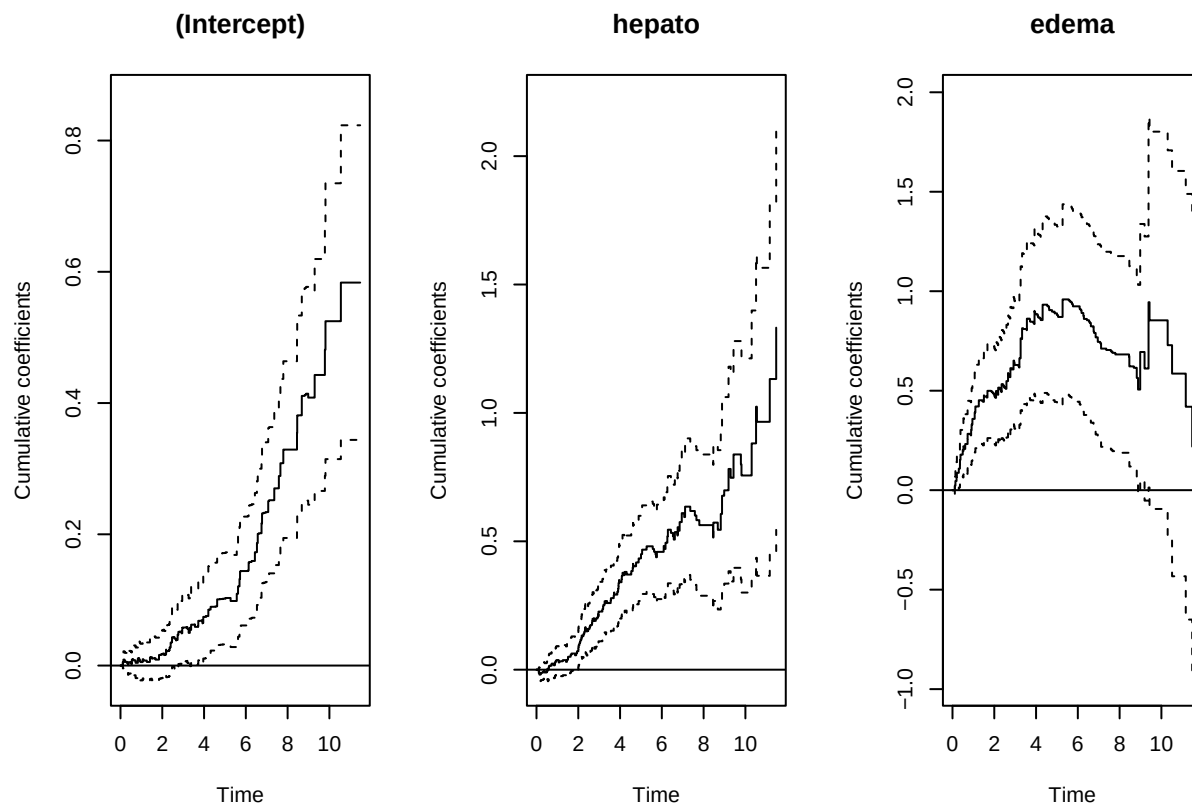
```
##           time (Intercept)      hepato      edema
## [1,] 0.0000000 0.000000000 0.000000000 0.00000000
## [2,] 0.1122519 0.004491233 -0.009449554 0.02266661
## [3,] 0.1396304 0.009107843 -0.019162903 0.04596598
## [4,] 0.1943874 0.007479550 -0.015736974 0.06631965
## [5,] 0.2108145 0.005814371 -0.012233437 0.08713439
## [6,] 0.3011636 0.004110596 -0.008648694 0.10843157
```

```
summary(a1)
```

```
## Additive Aalen Model
##
## Test for nonparametric terms
##
## Test for non-significant effects
##           Supremum-test of significance p-value H_0: B(t)=0
## (Intercept)                5.01                0.000
## hepato                    5.33                0.000
## edema                     4.43                0.001
##
## Test for time invariant effects
##           Kolmogorov-Smirnov test p-value H_0:constant effect
## (Intercept)                0.174                0.046
## hepato                    0.468                0.188
## edema                     0.858                0.022
##           Cramer von Mises test p-value H_0:constant effect
## (Intercept)                0.109                0.027
## hepato                    0.601                0.212
## edema                     3.890                0.002
##
##
## Call:
## aalen(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
```

Both hepato and edema have a significant effect on survival (null hypothesis of $\beta(t) = 0$ is rejected). The null hypothesis of $\beta(t)$ being constant is rejected for edema, not for hepato (note that this assumption is not the PH assumption). A plot function for the result is provided.

```
# pdf("Ah_Bt.pdf", width = 8, height = 5)
par(mfrow = c(1, 3))
plot(a1, pointwise.ci = 2)
```



```
# dev.off()
```

We now derive the survival curves for the same four patients.

```
ah1 <- a1$cum
ah1 <- as.data.frame(ah1)
names(ah1) <- dimnames(ah1)[[2]]
names(ah1)[2] <- "intercept"
head(ah1)

##      time  intercept    hepato    edema
## 1 0.000000 0.000000000 0.000000000 0.00000000
## 2 0.1122519 0.004491233 -0.009449554 0.02266661
## 3 0.1396304 0.009107843 -0.019162903 0.04596598
## 4 0.1943874 0.007479550 -0.015736974 0.06631965
## 5 0.2108145 0.005814371 -0.012233437 0.08713439
## 6 0.3011636 0.004110596 -0.008648694 0.10843157

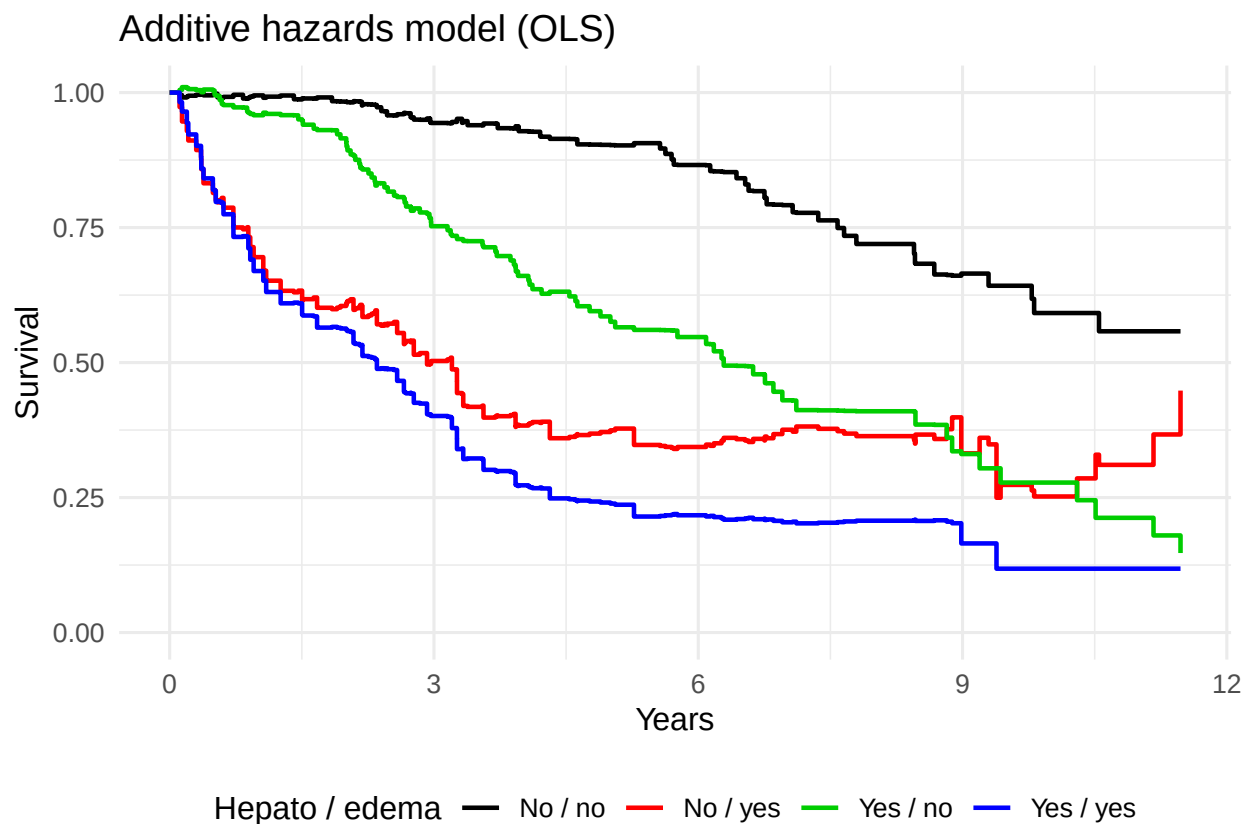
b00 <- data.frame(time = ah1$time, Haz = ah1$intercept)
b00$surv <- exp(-b00$Haz)
b01 <- data.frame(
  time = ah1$time, Haz = ah1$intercept + ah1$edema
)
```

```

b01$urv <- exp(-b01$Haz)
b10 <- data.frame(
  time = ah1$time, Haz = ah1$intercept + ah1$hepato
)
b10$urv <- exp(-b10$Haz)
b11 <- data.frame(
  time = ah1$time,
  Haz = ah1$intercept + ah1$hepato + ah1$edema
)
b11$urv <- exp(-b11$Haz)

# pdf("Ah_nonpar_survival.pdf")
par(mfrow = c(1, 1))
df_ah1 <- combine_he(b00, b01, b10, b11)
p_ah1 <- plot_he_survival(
  df_ah1, "Additive hazards model (OLS)", type = "step"
)
p_ah1

```



```

# dev.off()

```

```

b00_OLS <- b00
b01_OLS <- b01
b10_OLS <- b10
b11_OLS <- b11

```

Note the non-monotone behavior of in particular the hepato no, edema yes curve.

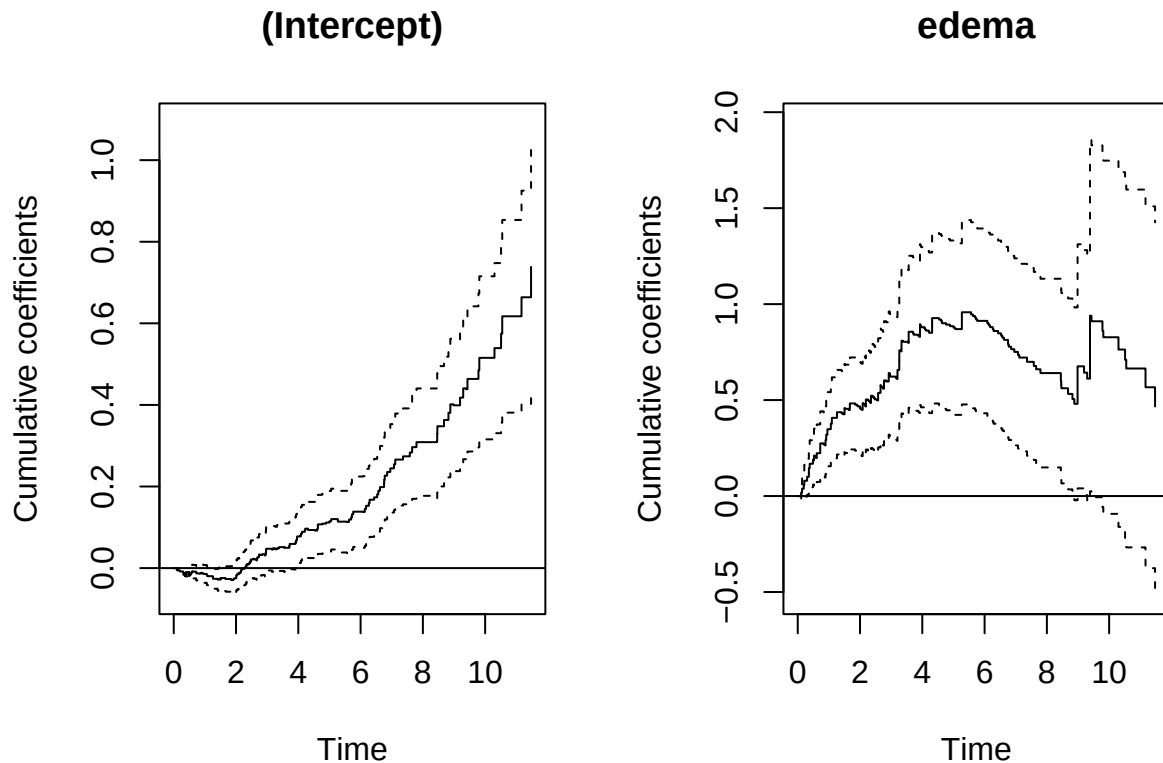
Since the effect of hepato seemed to be time-constant, we also fit a model with a constant effect of hepato.

```

a2 <- aalen(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ const(hepato) + edema, data = pbc)
summary(a2)

## Additive Aalen Model
##
## Test for nonparametric terms
##
## Test for non-significant effects
##           Supremum-test of significance p-value H_0: B(t)=0
## (Intercept)                5.29                0
## edema                    4.42                0
##
## Test for time invariant effects
##           Kolmogorov-Smirnov test p-value H_0:constant effect
## (Intercept)                0.254                0.047
## edema                    0.752                0.009
##           Cramer von Mises test p-value H_0:constant effect
## (Intercept)                0.339                0.009
## edema                    2.500                0.003
##
## Parametric terms :
##           Coef.      SE Robust SE      z      P-val lower2.5% upper97.5%
## const(hepato) 0.0828 0.0148      0.0147 5.62 1.89e-08      0.0538      0.112
##
## Call:
## aalen(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ const(hepato) + edema, data = pbc)
par(mfrow = c(1, 2))
plot(a2, pointwise.ci = 2)

```



The estimated cumulative curves for intercept (cumulative baseline hazard) and **edema** have not fundamentally changed, but note that the cumulative baseline hazard estimate is negative until just past $t = 2$. Also for this model we derive the survival curves for the same four patients.

```
ah2 <- a2$cum
ah2 <- as.data.frame(ah2)
names(ah2) <- dimnames(ah2)[[2]]
names(ah2)[2] <- "intercept"
head(ah2)

##      time  intercept  edema
## 1 0.000000 0.000000000 0.0000000
## 2 0.1122519 -0.004418754 0.01818616
## 3 0.1396304 -0.005496499 0.03844380
## 4 0.1943874 -0.007651989 0.05849864
## 5 0.2108145 -0.008298636 0.07987880
## 6 0.3011636 -0.011855194 0.10017005

b00 <- data.frame(time = ah2$time, Haz = ah2$intercept)
b00$surv <- exp(-b00$Haz)
b01 <- data.frame(
  time = ah2$time, Haz = ah2$intercept + ah2$edema
```

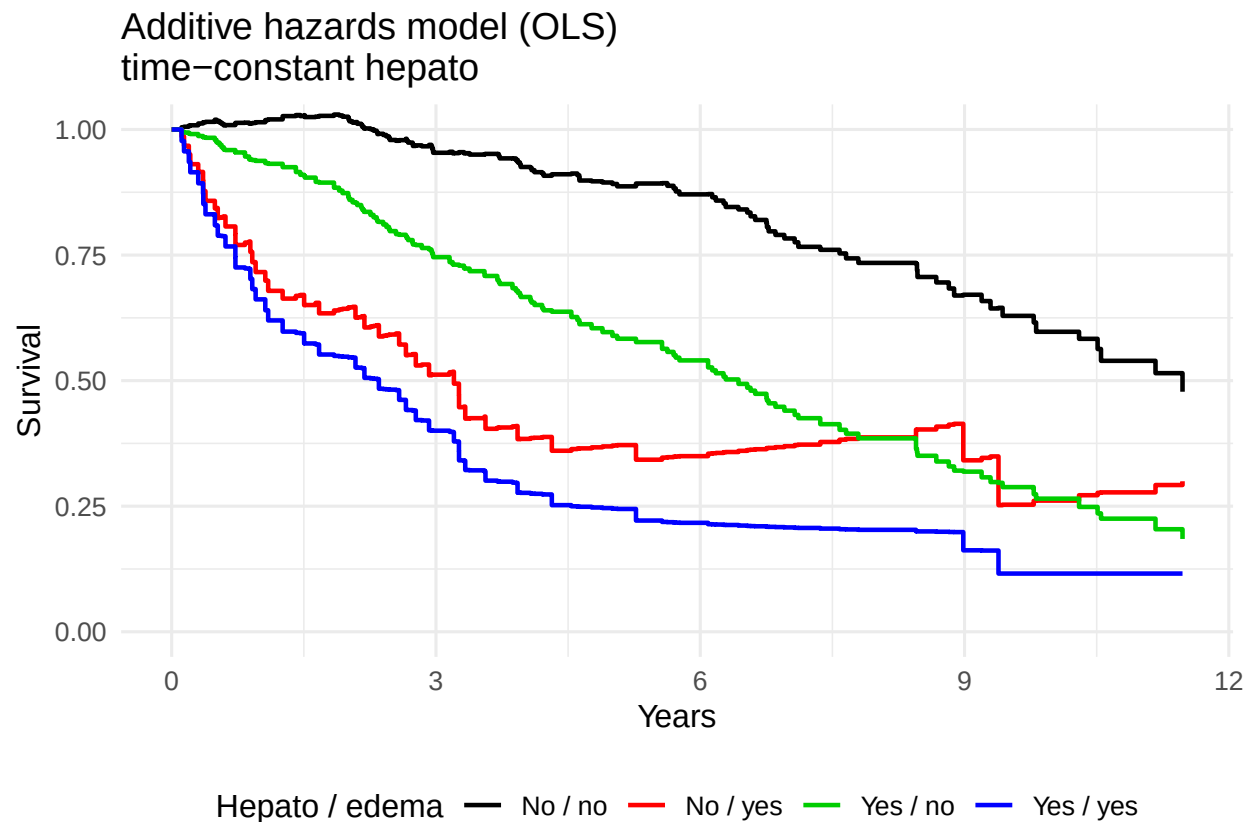


```

)
b01$surv <- exp(-b01$Haz)
b10 <- data.frame(
  time = ah2$time,
  Haz = ah2$intercept + ah2$time * c(a2$gamma)
)
b10$surv <- exp(-b10$Haz)
b11 <- data.frame(
  time = ah2$time,
  Haz = ah2$intercept + ah2$time * c(a2$gamma) + ah2$edema
)
b11$surv <- exp(-b11$Haz)

# pdf("Ah_McKS_survival.pdf")
par(mfrow = c(1, 1))
df_ah2 <- combine_he(b00, b01, b10, b11)
p_ah2 <- plot_he_survival(
  df_ah2,
  "Additive hazards model (OLS)\ntime-constant hepato",
  type = "step"
)
p_ah2

```



```
# dev.off()
```

We can now also see the model-based survival curve for no hepato, no edema being larger than one (consistent with the cumulative baseline hazard being negative).

```
b00_OLS_tc <- b00
b01_OLS_tc <- b01
b10_OLS_tc <- b10
b11_OLS_tc <- b11
```

Finally we consider the MLE estimates of Lu et al. (2023).

```
a3 <- ah(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
a3 <- a3$cumbeta

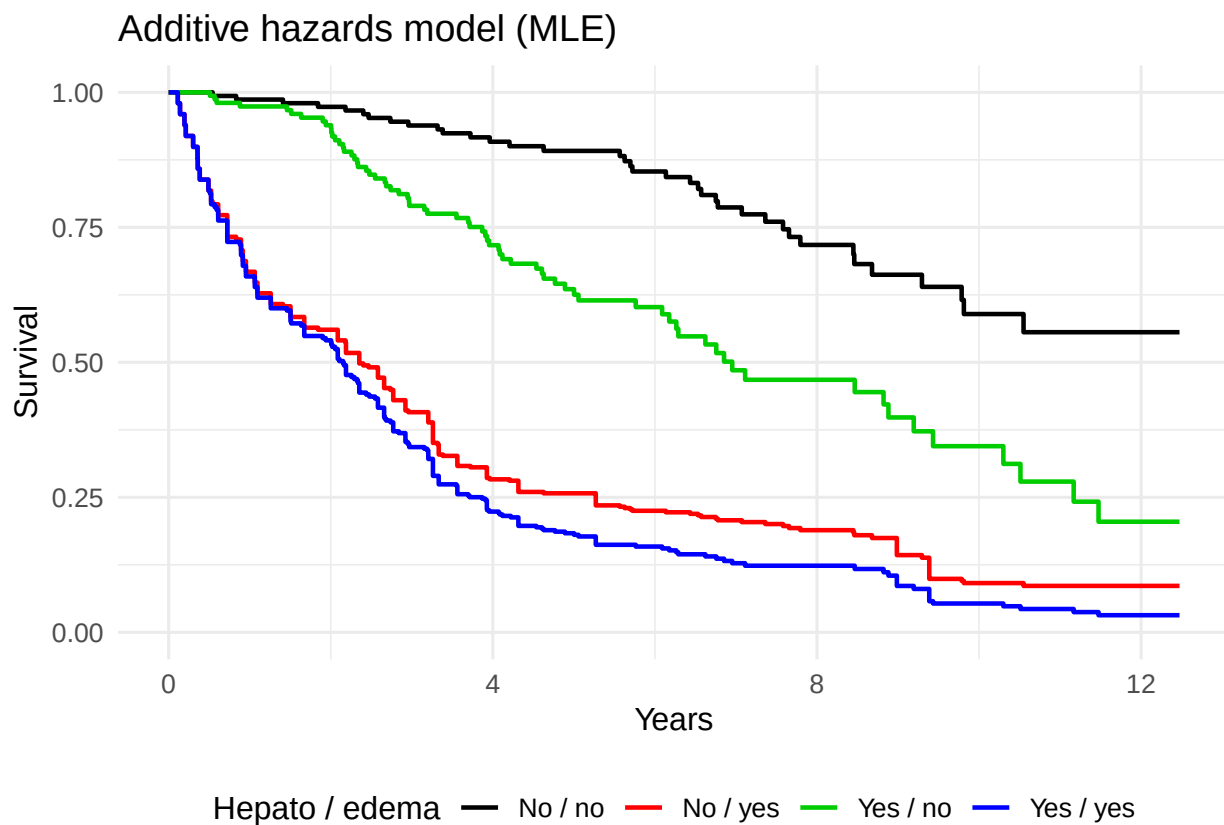
# Survival curves for the same four patients
b00 <- data.frame(time = a3$time, Haz = a3$intercept)
b00$surv <- exp(-b00$Haz)
b01 <- data.frame(time = a3$time, Haz = a3$intercept + a3$edema)
b01$surv <- exp(-b01$Haz)
b10 <- data.frame(time = a3$time, Haz = a3$intercept + a3$hepato)
b10$surv <- exp(-b10$Haz)
b11 <- data.frame(
```

```

time = a3$time,
Haz = a3$intercept + a3$hepato + a3$edema
)
b11$surv <- exp(-b11$Haz)

# pdf("Ah_MLE_survival.pdf")
par(mfrow = c(1, 1))
df_ah3 <- combine_he(b00, b01, b10, b11)
p_ah3 <- plot_he_survival(
  df_ah3, "Additive hazards model (MLE)", type = "step"
)
p_ah3

```



```
# dev.off()
```

Note that all mode-based survival curves are monotone, but especially the hepato no, edema yes curve is quite different from the previous additive hazard curves.

```

b00_MLE <- b00
b01_MLE <- b01
b10_MLE <- b10
b11_MLE <- b11

```

AFT models

Finally we consider AFT models, first parametric, then semi-parametric AFT models.

Parametric AFT models

We start with parametric AFT models, first `survreg()` from the `survival` package.

```
tic("survreg from {survival}")
ls.sur.weib <- survreg(
  Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc
)
toc()
```

```
## survreg from {survival}: 0.54 sec elapsed
```

```
summary(ls.sur.weib)
```

```
##
## Call:
## survreg(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
##              Value Std. Error      z      p
## (Intercept)  2.9566      0.1387 21.32 < 2e-16
## hepato      -0.8141      0.1529 -5.32 1.0e-07
## edema       -0.8674      0.1613 -5.38 7.5e-08
## Log(scale)  -0.2260      0.0695 -3.25 0.0011
##
## Scale= 0.798
##
## Weibull distribution
## Loglik(model)= -463.4   Loglik(intercept only)= -498.6
##  Chisq= 70.44 on 2 degrees of freedom, p= 5.1e-16
## Number of Newton-Raphson Iterations: 5
## n= 312
```

It is instructive to see what happens if we use the original time scale, days, rather than years. From the results we see that the estimated regression coefficients for `hepato` and `edema` remain the same, but the intercept has changed.

```
tic("survreg from {survival}, time in days")
ls.sur.weib2 <- survreg(
  Surv(time, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc
)
toc()
```

```
## survreg from {survival}, time in days: 0.01 sec elapsed
```

```
summary(ls.sur.weib2)
```

```
##
## Call:
## survreg(formula = Surv(time, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
##           Value Std. Error      z      p
## (Intercept)  8.8572      0.1387 63.86 < 2e-16
## hepato      -0.8141      0.1529 -5.32 1.0e-07
## edema       -0.8674      0.1613 -5.38 7.5e-08
## Log(scale)  -0.2260      0.0695 -3.25 0.0011
##
## Scale= 0.798
##
## Weibull distribution
## Loglik(model)= -1313   Loglik(intercept only)= -1348.3
##  Chisq= 70.44 on 2 degrees of freedom, p= 5.1e-16
## Number of Newton-Raphson Iterations: 5
## n= 312
```

Many other parametric distributions can be used in `survreg()`, like for instance the logistic distributions.

```
tic("survreg with logistic distribution")
ls.sur.logistic <- survreg(
  Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  dist = "logistic"
)
toc()
```

```
## survreg with logistic distribution: 0 sec elapsed
```

```
summary(ls.sur.logistic)
```

```
##
## Call:
## survreg(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##       dist = "logistic")
##           Value Std. Error      z      p
## (Intercept) 10.3073      0.4935 20.89 < 2e-16
## hepato      -3.7487      0.5887 -6.37 1.9e-10
## edema       -4.1063      0.6748 -6.09 1.2e-09
## Log(scale)   0.8716      0.0685 12.73 < 2e-16
##
## Scale= 2.39
##
## Logistic distribution
```

```
## Loglik(model)= -497.5   Loglik(intercept only)= -539.8
##  Chisq= 84.64 on 2 degrees of freedom, p= 4.2e-19
## Number of Newton-Raphson Iterations: 4
## n= 312
```

About the parametrization of the Weibull distribution. The function `flexsurvreg()` in the `flexsurv` package fits AFT Weibull models with a parametrization more in line with that used in the paper (and models with other parametric error distributions). So let's fit the Weibull AFT model using `flexsurvreg()`, and also AFT models with a range of other distributions, including the generalized gamma distribution.

```
fitw <- flexsurvreg(
  Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  dist = "weibull"
)
fitl <- flexsurvreg(
  Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  dist = "llogis"
)
# Named fitgg (not fitg) to avoid colliding with the Gompertz fit
# below - the original script assigned both to fitg, so the
# gengamma fit was being silently overwritten by the Gompertz
# one.
fitgg <- flexsurvreg(
  Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  dist = "gengamma"
)
fitn <- flexsurvreg(
  Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  dist = "lnorm"
)
fitf <- flexsurvreg(
  Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  dist = "genf"
)
fitg <- flexsurvreg(
  Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  dist = "gompertz"
)
fitw
```

```
## Call:
## flexsurvreg(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##             dist = "weibull")
##
## Estimates:
```

```
##           data mean  est      L95%      U95%      se      exp(est)  L95%      U95%
## shape           NA    1.2536    1.0940    1.4365    0.0871         NA         NA         NA
## scale           NA   19.2331   14.6553   25.2409    2.6675         NA         NA         NA
## hepato    0.5128   -0.8141   -1.1137   -0.5144    0.1529    0.4431    0.3283    0.5978
## edema     0.1571   -0.8674   -1.1835   -0.5514    0.1613    0.4200    0.3062    0.5762
##
## N = 312,  Events: 144,  Censored: 168
## Total time at risk: 1713.854
## Log-likelihood = -463.3634, df = 4
## AIC = 934.7267
```

```
fitl
```

```
## Call:
## flexsurvreg(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##           dist = "llogis")
##
## Estimates:
##           data mean  est      L95%      U95%      se      exp(est)  L95%      U95%
## shape           NA    1.637    1.425    1.880    0.116         NA         NA         NA
## scale           NA   14.396   11.309   18.325    1.773         NA         NA         NA
## hepato    0.513   -0.815   -1.102   -0.528    0.146    0.443    0.332    0.590
## edema     0.157   -1.265   -1.634   -0.896    0.188    0.282    0.195    0.408
##
## N = 312,  Events: 144,  Censored: 168
## Total time at risk: 1713.854
## Log-likelihood = -457.5594, df = 4
## AIC = 923.1187
```

```
fitgg
```

```
## Call:
## flexsurvreg(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##           dist = "gengamma")
##
## Estimates:
##           data mean  est      L95%      U95%      se      exp(est)  L95%      U95%
## mu           NA    2.789    2.488    3.090    0.154         NA         NA         NA
## sigma        NA    1.049    0.860    1.279    0.106         NA         NA         NA
## Q            NA    0.232   -0.283    0.747    0.263         NA         NA         NA
## hepato    0.513   -0.813   -1.117   -0.509    0.155    0.444    0.327    0.601
## edema     0.157   -1.279   -1.733   -0.825    0.231    0.278    0.177    0.438
##
## N = 312,  Events: 144,  Censored: 168
## Total time at risk: 1713.854
## Log-likelihood = -458.9447, df = 5
```

```
## AIC = 927.8895
```

```
fitn
```

```
## Call:
## flexsurvreg(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##     dist = "lnorm")
##
## Estimates:
##           data mean  est      L95%      U95%      se      exp(est)  L95%
## meanlog      NA    2.7158  2.4557   2.9759   0.1327      NA      NA
## sdlog        NA    1.1186  0.9898   1.2642   0.0698      NA      NA
## hepato      0.5128  -0.7901 -1.0936  -0.4865   0.1549   0.4538   0.3350
## edema       0.1571  -1.4046 -1.7724  -1.0368   0.1877   0.2455   0.1699
##           U95%
## meanlog      NA
## sdlog        NA
## hepato      0.6147
## edema       0.3546
##
## N = 312,  Events: 144,  Censored: 168
## Total time at risk: 1713.854
## Log-likelihood = -459.3138, df = 4
## AIC = 926.6276
```

```
fitf
```

```
## Call:
## flexsurvreg(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##     dist = "genf")
##
## Estimates:
##           data mean  est      L95%      U95%      se      exp(est)  L95%      U95%
## mu          NA    2.544  2.141   2.947   0.206      NA      NA      NA
## sigma       NA    0.821  0.558   1.209   0.162      NA      NA      NA
## Q           NA   -0.337 -1.257   0.583   0.469      NA      NA      NA
## P           NA    1.588  0.330   7.645   1.273      NA      NA      NA
## hepato     0.513   -0.800 -1.086  -0.514   0.146   0.449   0.338   0.598
## edema      0.157   -1.354 -1.820  -0.888   0.238   0.258   0.162   0.412
##
## N = 312,  Events: 144,  Censored: 168
## Total time at risk: 1713.854
## Log-likelihood = -457.254, df = 6
## AIC = 926.508
```



```
fitg
```

```
## Call:
## flexsurvreg(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##   dist = "gompertz")
##
## Estimates:
##      data mean   est      L95%      U95%      se      exp(est)      L95%      U95%
## shape      NA    0.0871  0.0306  0.1435  0.0288      NA      NA      NA
## rate      NA    0.0283  0.0191  0.0420  0.0057      NA      NA      NA
## hepato  0.5128    1.0209  0.6587  1.3831  0.1848  2.7756  1.9322  3.9872
## edema   0.1571    1.0633  0.6863  1.4404  0.1924  2.8960  1.9863  4.2223
##
## N = 312,  Events: 144,  Censored: 168
## Total time at risk: 1713.854
## Log-likelihood = -463.8338, df = 4
## AIC = 935.6676
```

Package eha has the function `aftreg()` that fits parametric AFT models. Default is the Weibull distributions, but also loglogistic, lognormal and Gompertz distributions are supported. The same results are obtained as with other packages, at least with respect to the regression coefficients. It is unclear where for instance the shape and scale of the Weibull model can be found.

```
aftregw <- aftreg(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
summary(aftregw)
```

```
## Covariate      W.mean      Coef Time-Accn  se(Coef)      LR p
## hepato         0.432      0.814    2.257    0.153    0.0000
## edema          0.094      0.868    2.381    0.161    0.0000
##
## Events          144
## Total time at risk 1713.9
## Max. log. likelihood -463.36
## LR test statistic  70.44
## Degrees of freedom  2
## Overall p-value   5.55112e-16
```

```
aftregll <- aftreg(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  dist = "loglogistic")
summary(aftregll)
```

```
## Covariate      W.mean      Coef Time-Accn  se(Coef)      LR p
## hepato         0.432      0.815    2.259    0.146    0.0000
## edema          0.094      1.265    3.543    0.188    0.0000
##
```

```
## Events 144
## Total time at risk 1713.9
## Max. log. likelihood -457.56
## LR test statistic 85.52
## Degrees of freedom 2
## Overall p-value 0
```

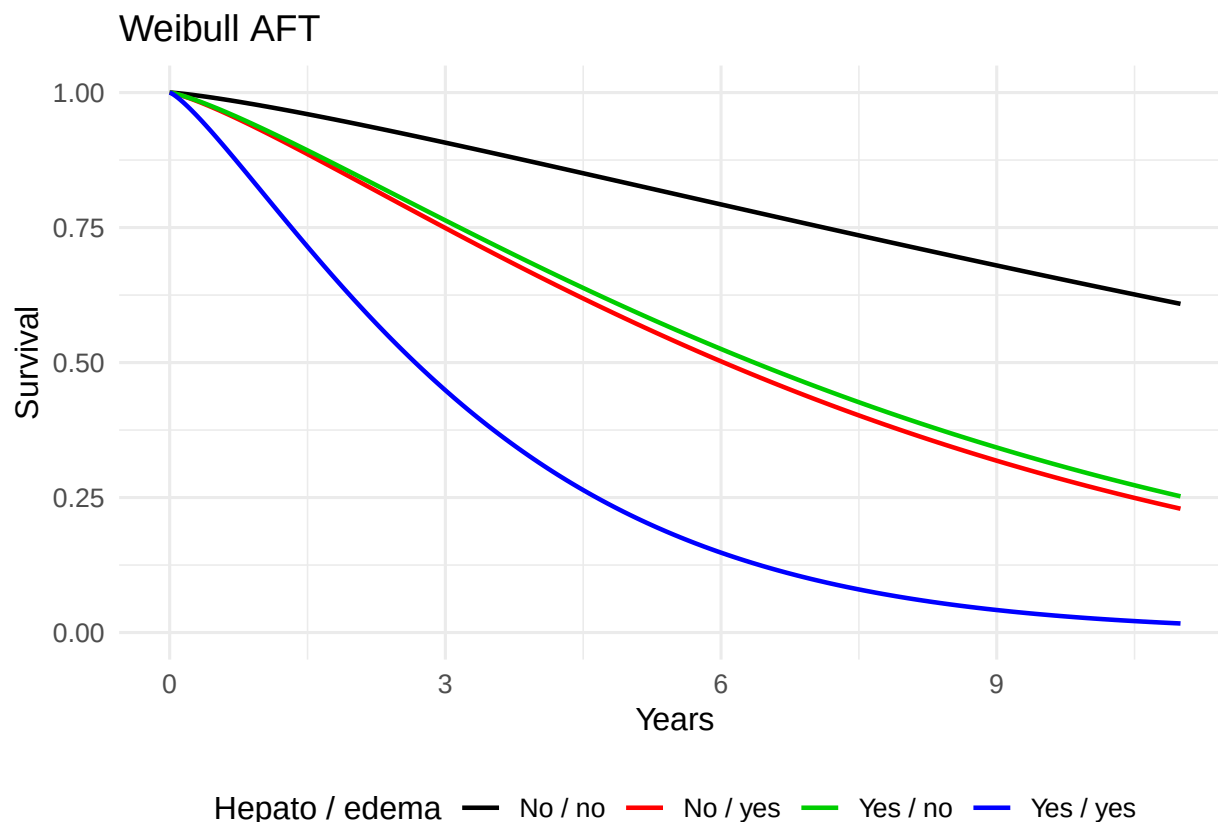
The function `psm()` from the `rms` package also fits AFT models. From this it also seems to be easier to get predicted survival functions. The following code provides model-based survival curves for the four groups.

```
mySweibull <- function(x, rate, shape)
{
  return(exp( - rate * x^shape))
}
psm.weib <- psm(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
psm.weib

## Parametric Survival Model: Weibull Distribution
##
## psm(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
##
##               Model Likelihood   Discrimination
##               Ratio Test           Indexes
## Obs          312    LR chi2      70.44    R2          0.211
## Events       144    d.f.          2      R2(2,312)0.197
## sigma 0.7977    Pr(> chi2) <0.0001    R2(2,144)0.378
##                                     Dxy          0.421
##
##               Coef    S.E.    Wald Z Pr(>|Z|)
## (Intercept)  2.9566 0.1387 21.32 <0.0001
## hepato       -0.8141 0.1529 -5.32 <0.0001
## edema        -0.8674 0.1613 -5.38 <0.0001
## Log(scale)  -0.2260 0.0695 -3.25 0.0011

sig <- psm.weib$scale
lp <- predict(psm.weib, newdata = nd00, type = "lp")
tseq <- seq(0, 11, by = 0.01)
p00 <- mySweibull(tseq, shape = 1 / sig, rate = exp(-lp / sig))
lp <- predict(psm.weib, newdata = nd01, type = "lp")
p01 <- mySweibull(tseq, shape = 1 / sig, rate = exp(-lp / sig))
lp <- predict(psm.weib, newdata = nd10, type = "lp")
p10 <- mySweibull(tseq, shape = 1 / sig, rate = exp(-lp / sig))
lp <- predict(psm.weib, newdata = nd11, type = "lp")
p11 <- mySweibull(tseq, shape = 1 / sig, rate = exp(-lp / sig))
```

```
# pdf("AFT_Weibull_survival.pdf")
df_weib <- combine_he(
  data.frame(time = tseq, surv = p00),
  data.frame(time = tseq, surv = p01),
  data.frame(time = tseq, surv = p10),
  data.frame(time = tseq, surv = p11)
)
plot_he_survival(df_weib, "Weibull AFT", type = "line")
```



```
# dev.off()
```

Semi-parametric AFT models

It turns out you need to be quite careful with using time or log(time) when calling different functions. Those that take the linear regression model as starting point need log(time), because the outcome is log(time), with the issue being that this outcome sometimes is right-censored.

```
tic("lss from {lss2}")
ls.lss <- lss(
  Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  mcsizes = 100
```

```

)

##
## Converged. Criteria Satisfied: 0.001
toc()

## lss from {lss2}: 20.25 sec elapsed
ls.lss

##
## Call:
## lss(formula = Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##      mcsize = 100)
##
## Number of Observations: 312
## Number of Events: 144
## Number of Censored: 168
## Number of Iterations: 4
## Resampling Number: 100
##
## Gehan Estimator:
##      Estimate Std. Error  Z value    Pr(>|Z|)
## hepato -0.7807529  0.1528887 -5.106675 3.278776e-07
## edema -1.4846471  0.2901092 -5.117546 3.095364e-07
##
## Least-Squares Estimator:
##      Estimate Std. Error  Z value    Pr(>|Z|)
## hepato -0.7795449  0.1505485 -5.178032 2.242382e-07
## edema -1.4001970  0.2371112 -5.905233 3.521480e-09

```

The package aftgee uses time itself (not log(time)). Computation is much faster.

```

tic("aftgee from {aftgee}")
aft1 <- aftgee(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
toc()

```

```
## aftgee from {aftgee}: 0.24 sec elapsed
```

```
summary(aft1)
```

```

## Call:
## aftgee(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
##
## AFTGEE Estimator
##      Estimate StdErr z.value  p.value
## (Intercept)   2.692  0.127  21.238 < 2.2e-16 ***

```

```
## hepato      -0.780  0.157  -4.963 < 2.2e-16 ***
## edema       -1.400  0.209  -6.693 < 2.2e-16 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
```

The package aftsem again needs log(time) to be specified. It seems much faster than aftgee, but that is only when no SE's are computed.

```
tic("aftsem from {aftsem}, buckley")
aftsem1 <- aftsem(
  Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  method = "buckley"
)
toc()
```

```
## aftsem from {aftsem}, buckley: 0.02 sec elapsed
```

```
summary(aftsem1)
```

```
## AFT Semiparametric Model Summary
## =====
##
## Model Call: aftsem(formula = Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##   Model Call:      method = "buckley")
##
## Used parameter estimation method:
## [1] "buckley"
##
## Convergence Status: Not Converged
##
## Estimated Parameters:
##           [,1]
## [1,] -0.7789486
## [2,] -1.3997578
##
## Estimated Intercept:
## [1] 0
## Number of Iterations: 15
## Number of Observations: 312
## Percent of Censored Observations: 53.850000
##
## Initial Beta Estimate:
##      Zhepato      Zedema
## -0.2976519 -0.9589797
##
## Epsilon (Convergence Tolerance): 0.00001
## Maximum Iterations Allowed: 15
```

```
## Algorithm stopped after: 15 iterations
```

It turns out that 15 iterations is not enough for convergence (the same is true for the jin method coming up), but it is not really clear how to adjust this, so I am letting this go.

```
tic("aftsem from {aftsem}, jin")
aftsem2 <- aftsem(
  Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  method = "jin"
)
toc()
```

```
## aftsem from {aftsem}, jin: 0.21 sec elapsed
```

```
summary(aftsem2)
```

```
## AFT Semiparametric Model Summary
## =====
##
## Model Call: aftsem(formula = Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##   Model Call:      method = "jin")
##
## Used parameter estimation method:
## [1] "jin"
##
## Convergence Status: Not Converged
##
## Estimated Parameters:
##           [,1]
## [1,] -0.779088
## [2,] -1.399838
##
## Number of Iterations: 15
## Number of Observations: 312
## Percent of Censored Observations: 53.850000
##
## Initial Beta Estimate:
##           [,1]
## [1,] -0.7807529
## [2,] -1.4846471
##
## Epsilon (Convergence Tolerance): 0.00001
## Maximum Iterations Allowed: 15
## Algorithm stopped after: 15 iterations
```

```
tic("aftsem from {aftsem}, jin, with 100 resamples")
aftsem2 <- aftsem(
```

```
Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
method = "jin", resample = 100
)
toc()
```

aftsem from {aftsem}, jin, with 100 resamples: 18.51 sec elapsed

```
summary(aftsem2)
```

```
## AFT Semiparametric Model Summary
## =====
##
## Model Call: aftsem(formula = Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##   Model Call:      method = "jin", resample = 100)
##
## Used parameter estimation method:
## [1] "jin"
##
## Convergence Status: Not Converged
##
##           |Estimate| |Std. Error| |Z value| |Pr(>|Z|)|
## hepato    -0.779      0.150     -5.2    2.0e-07 ***
## edema     -1.400      0.222     -6.3    2.9e-10 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
## Number of Iterations: 15
## Number of Observations: 312
## Percent of Censored Observations: 53.850000
```

```
tic("aftsem from {aftsem}, gehan")
aftsem3 <- aftsem(
  Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  method = "gehan"
)
toc()
```

aftsem from {aftsem}, gehan: 0.17 sec elapsed

```
summary(aftsem3)
```

```
## AFT Semiparametric Model Summary
## =====
##
## Model Call: aftsem(formula = Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##   Model Call:      method = "gehan")
##
## Used parameter estimation method:
```

```

## [1] "gehan"
##
## Convergence Status: Converged
##
## Estimated Parameters:
##           [,1]
## [1,] -0.7807529
## [2,] -1.4846471
##
## Number of Observations: 312
## Percent of Censored Observations: 53.850000
##
## Initial Beta Estimate:
## Not available

tic("aftsem from {aftsem}, gehan, with 100 resamples")
aftsem3 <- aftsem(
  Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  method = "gehan", resample = 100
)
toc()

## aftsem from {aftsem}, gehan, with 100 resamples: 17.91 sec elapsed

summary(aftsem3)

## AFT Semiparametric Model Summary
## =====
##
## Model Call: aftsem(formula = Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##   Model Call:      method = "gehan", resample = 100)
##
## Used parameter estimation method:
## [1] "gehan"
##
## Convergence Status: Converged
##
##           |Estimate| |Std. Error| |Z value| |Pr(>|Z|)|
## hepato    -0.781      0.155    -5.03    4.8e-07 ***
## edema     -1.485      0.259    -5.74    9.4e-09 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
## Number of Observations: 312
## Percent of Censored Observations: 53.850000

tic("aftsem from {aftsem}, gehan-heller")
aftsem4 <- aftsem(

```



```
Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
method = "gehan-heller"
)
toc()
```

```
## aftsem from {aftsem}, gehan-heller: 1.09 sec elapsed
```

```
summary(aftsem4)
```

```
## AFT Semiparametric Model Summary
## =====
##
## Model Call: aftsem(formula = Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
##   Model Call:      method = "gehan-heller")
##
## Used parameter estimation method:
## [1] "gehan-heller"
##
## Convergence Status: Converged
##
## Estimated Parameters:
##           [,1]
## [1,] -0.8945909
## [2,] -1.4988955
##
## Number of Observations: 312
## Percent of Censored Observations: 53.850000
##
## Initial Beta Estimate:
##      Zhepato      Zedema
## -0.2976519 -0.9589797
```

```
tic("aftsem from {aftsem}, gehan-poly")
aftsem5 <- aftsem(
  Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
  method = "gehan-poly"
)
toc()
```

```
## aftsem from {aftsem}, gehan-poly: 0.28 sec elapsed
```

```
summary(aftsem5)
```

```
## AFT Semiparametric Model Summary
## =====
##
## Model Call: aftsem(formula = Surv(log(yrs), stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc,
```

```
## Model Call:      method = "gehan-poly")
##
## Used parameter estimation method:
## [1] "gehan-poly"
##
## Convergence Status: Converged
##
## Estimated Parameters:
##           [,1]
## [1,] -0.7807396
## [2,] -1.4846315
##
## Number of Observations: 312
## Percent of Censored Observations: 53.850000
##
## Initial Beta Estimate:
##      Zhepato      Zedema
## -0.2976519 -0.9589797
```

Finally, we have the Buckley-James estimator, implemented in the rms package. This packages uses time, not log(time).

```
tic("bj from {rms}")
ls.bj <- bj(Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
toc()
```

```
## bj from {rms}: 0.02 sec elapsed
```

```
ls.bj
```

```
## Buckley-James Censored Data Regression
##
## bj(formula = Surv(yrs, stat) ~ hepato + edema, data = pbc)
##
##                               Discrimination
##                               Indexes
## Obs      312      Regression d.f.2      g      0.706
## Events 144      sigma0.9103      gr      2.026
##                               d.f.      141
##
##      Coef      S.E.      Wald Z Pr(>|Z|)
## Intercept  2.6906 0.1400 19.22 <0.0001
## hepato    -0.7786 0.1668 -4.67 <0.0001
## edema     -1.3997 0.1743 -8.03 <0.0001
```

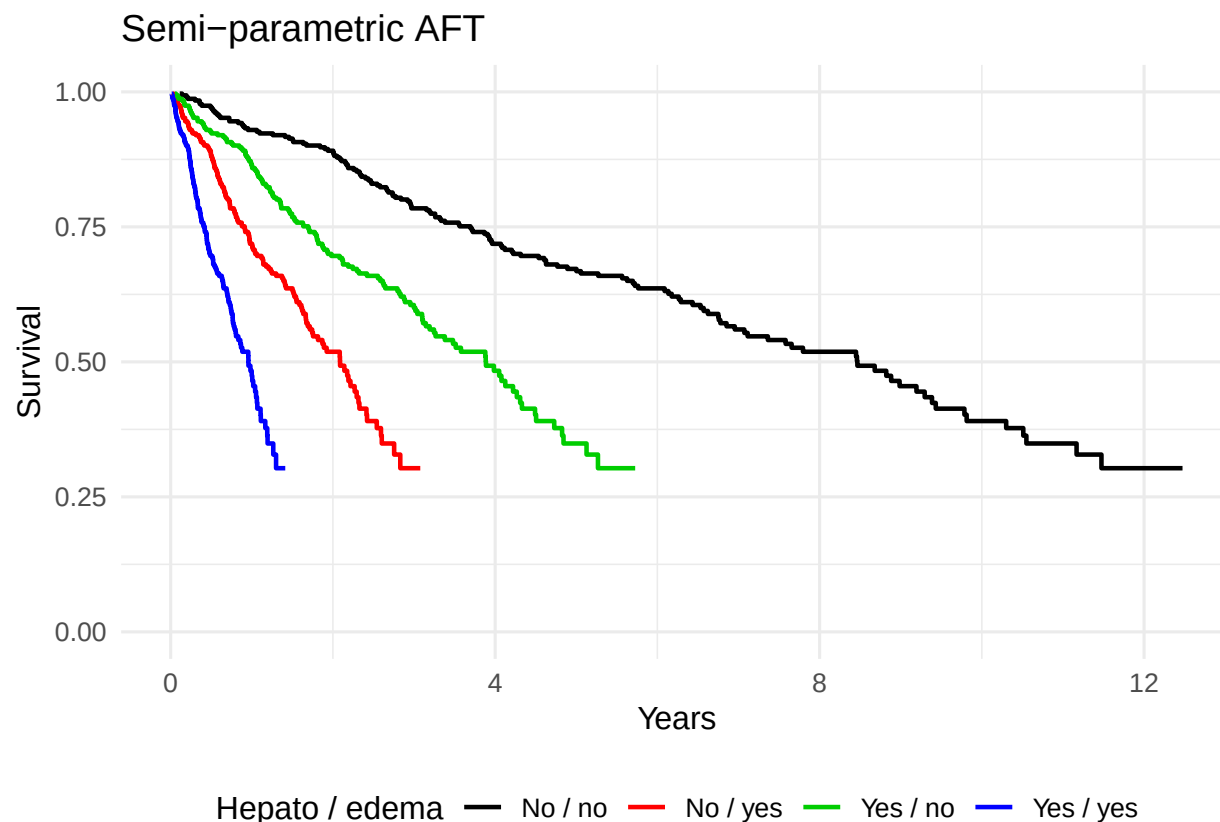
Here is an attempt to obtain model-based survival curves from the Buckley-James estimator (obtained from ls.bj).

```

scaled_yrs <- pbc$yrs
S00 <- survfit(Surv(scaled_yrs, pbc$stat) ~ 1)
scaled_yrs <- pbc$yrs * exp( ls.bj$coef[3] )
S01 <- survfit(Surv(scaled_yrs, pbc$stat) ~ 1)
scaled_yrs <- pbc$yrs * exp( ls.bj$coef[2] )
S10 <- survfit(Surv(scaled_yrs, pbc$stat) ~ 1)
scaled_yrs <- pbc$yrs * exp( ls.bj$coef[2] + ls.bj$coef[3])
S11 <- survfit(Surv(scaled_yrs, pbc$stat) ~ 1)

# pdf("AFT_semipar_survival.pdf")
# Using "step" for all four curves here (the original base R code
# only used type = "s" for S00; S01/S10/S11 were drawn with
# straight lines between survfit points, inconsistent with every
# other survival curve plot in this script - likely an
# oversight).
df_bj <- combine_he(
  data.frame(time = S00$time, surv = S00$surv),
  data.frame(time = S01$time, surv = S01$surv),
  data.frame(time = S10$time, surv = S10$surv),
  data.frame(time = S11$time, surv = S11$surv)
)
p_bj <- plot_he_survival(
  df_bj, "Semi-parametric AFT", type = "step"
)
p_bj

```



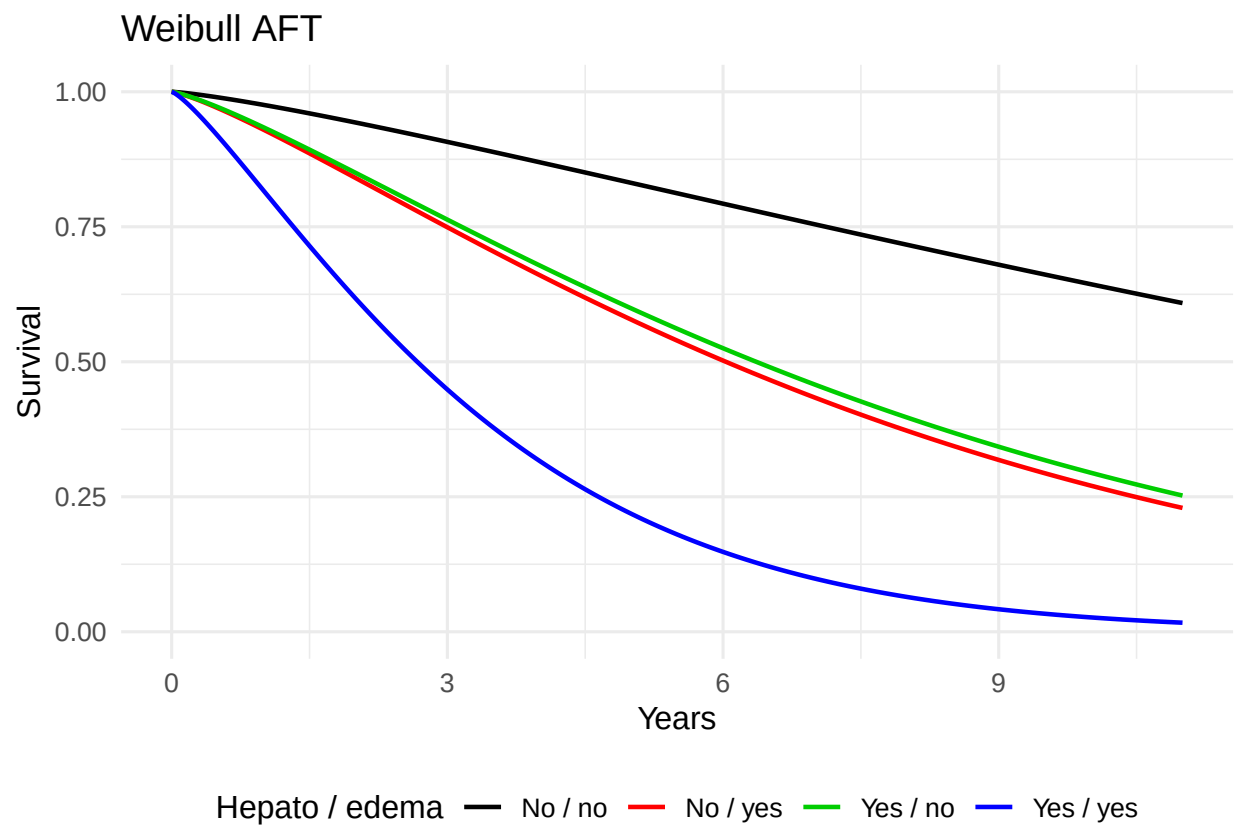
```
# dev.off()

# Try out plot function of flexsurvreg
nd <- data.frame(hepato = c(0, 0, 1, 1), edema = c(0, 1, 0, 1))
# nd's row order (00, 01, 10, 11) matches he_levels, so the four
# summary() curves below can be combined directly via
# combine_he().
flexsurv_he_df <- function(fit, t = tseq) {
  s <- summary(fit, newdata = nd, t = t, ci = FALSE)
  combine_he(
    data.frame(time = s[[1]]$time, surv = s[[1]]$est),
    data.frame(time = s[[2]]$time, surv = s[[2]]$est),
    data.frame(time = s[[3]]$time, surv = s[[3]]$est),
    data.frame(time = s[[4]]$time, surv = s[[4]]$est)
  )
}

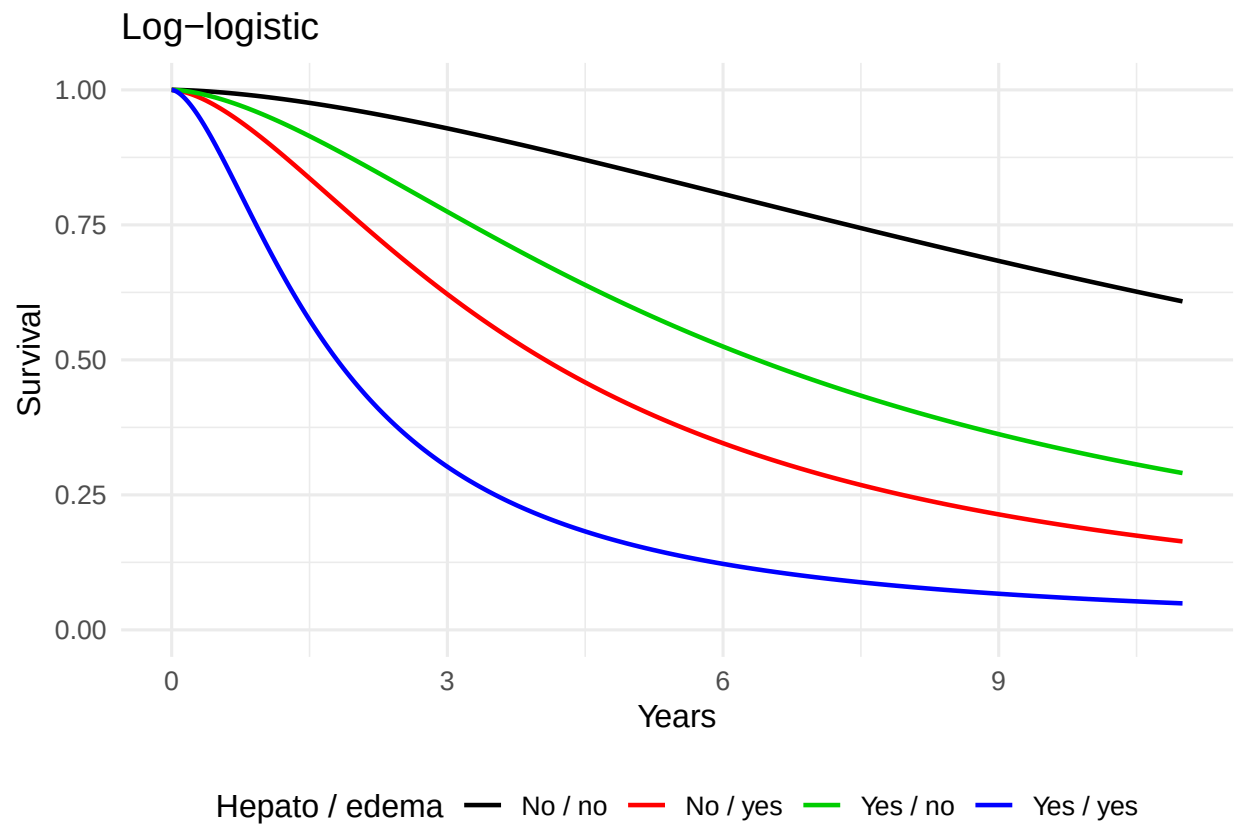
# (Set ci = TRUE in flexsurv_he_df()/summary() above, and add a
# ribbon geom in plot_he_survival(), to restore confidence
# bands.)

plot_he_survival(
```

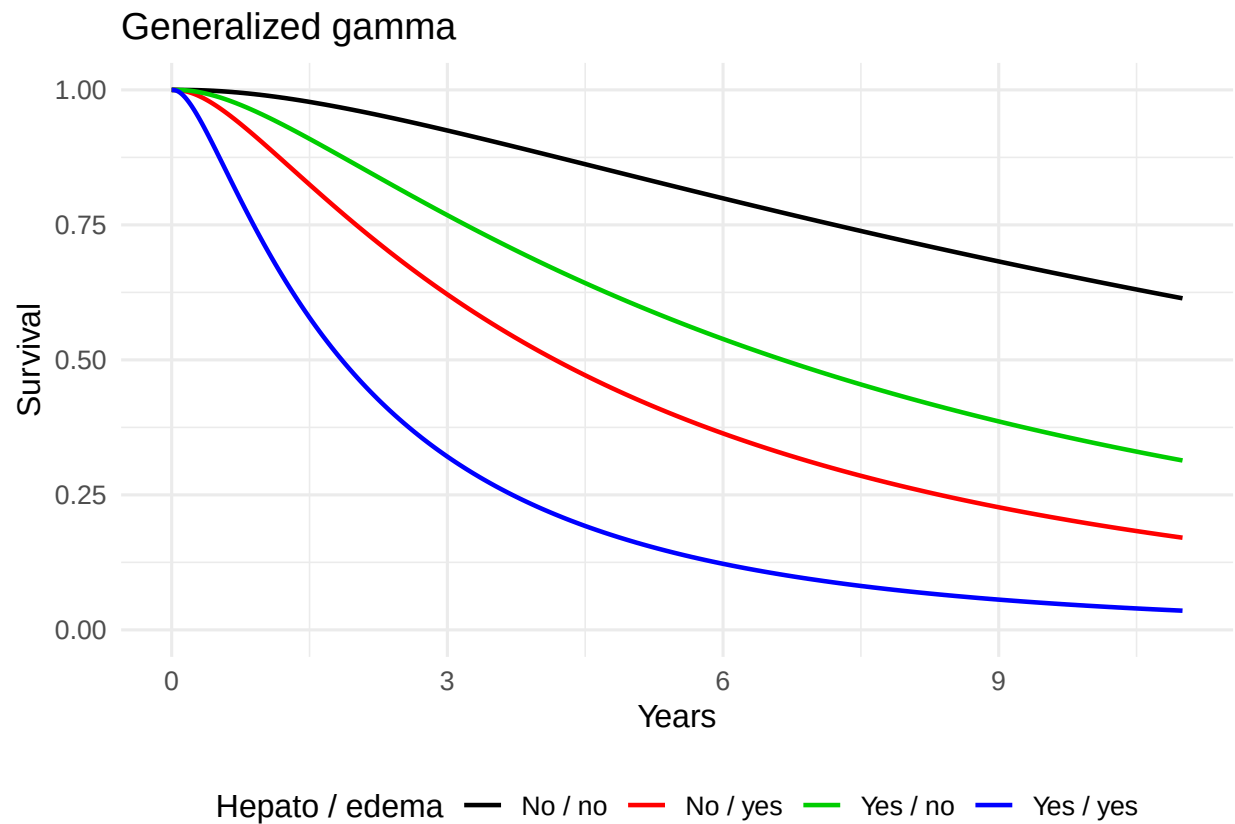
```
flexsurv_he_df(fitw), "Weibull AFT", type = "line"
)
```



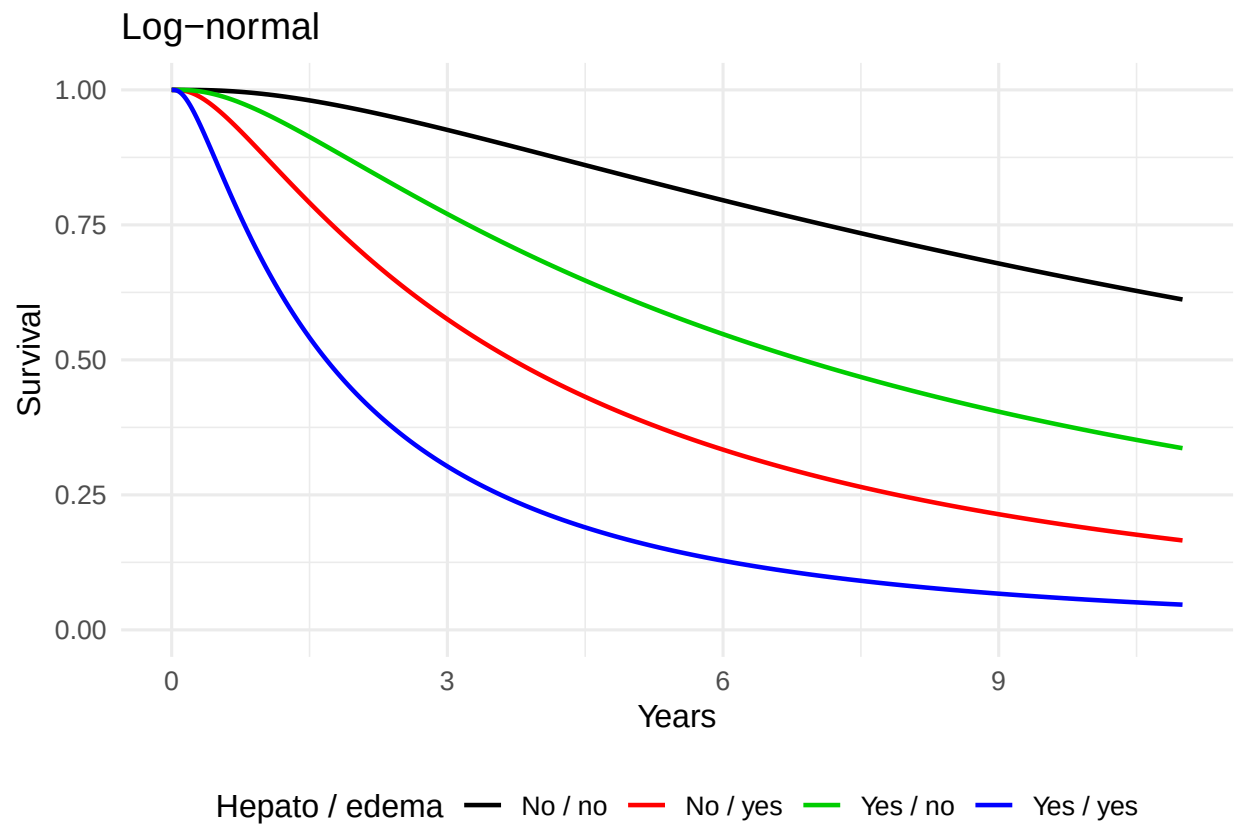
```
plot_he_survival(
  flexsurv_he_df(fitl), "Log-logistic", type = "line"
)
```



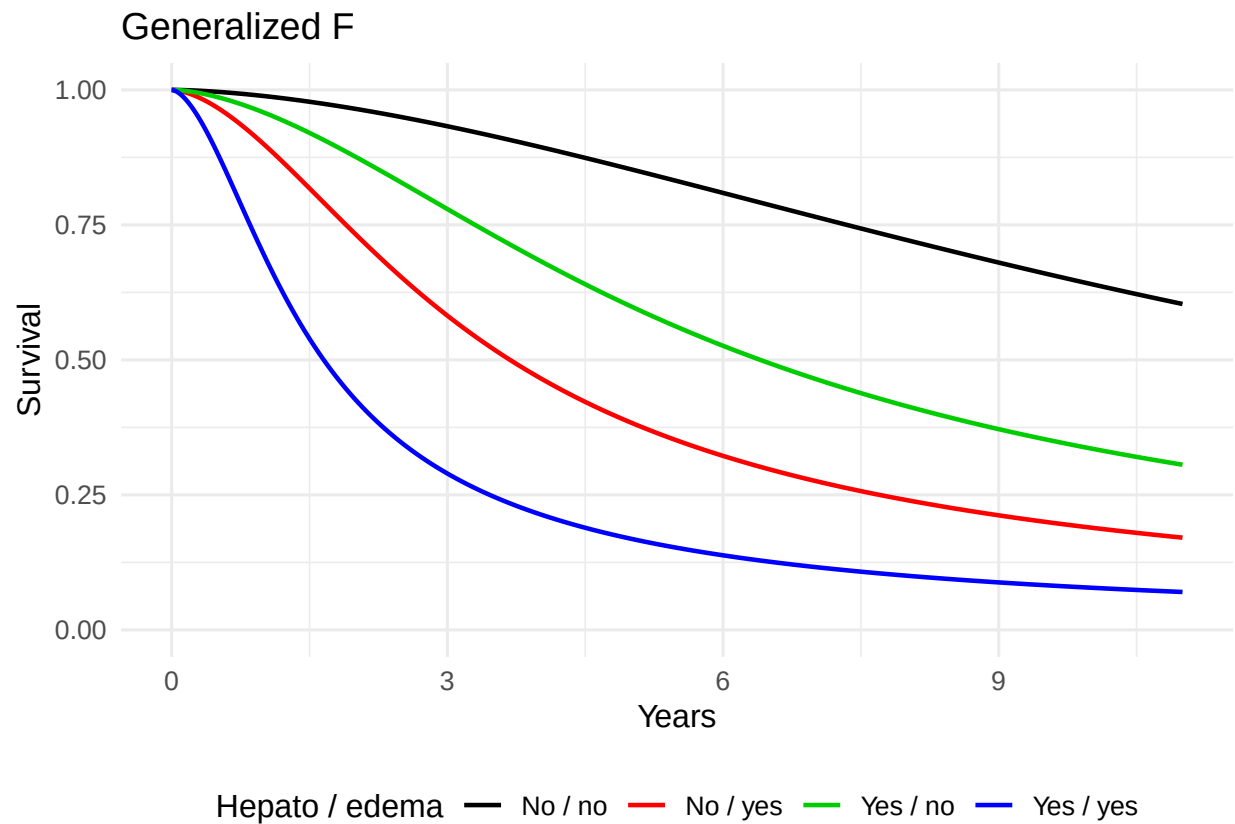
```
plot_he_survival(  
  flexsurv_he_df(fitgg), "Generalized gamma", type = "line"  
)
```



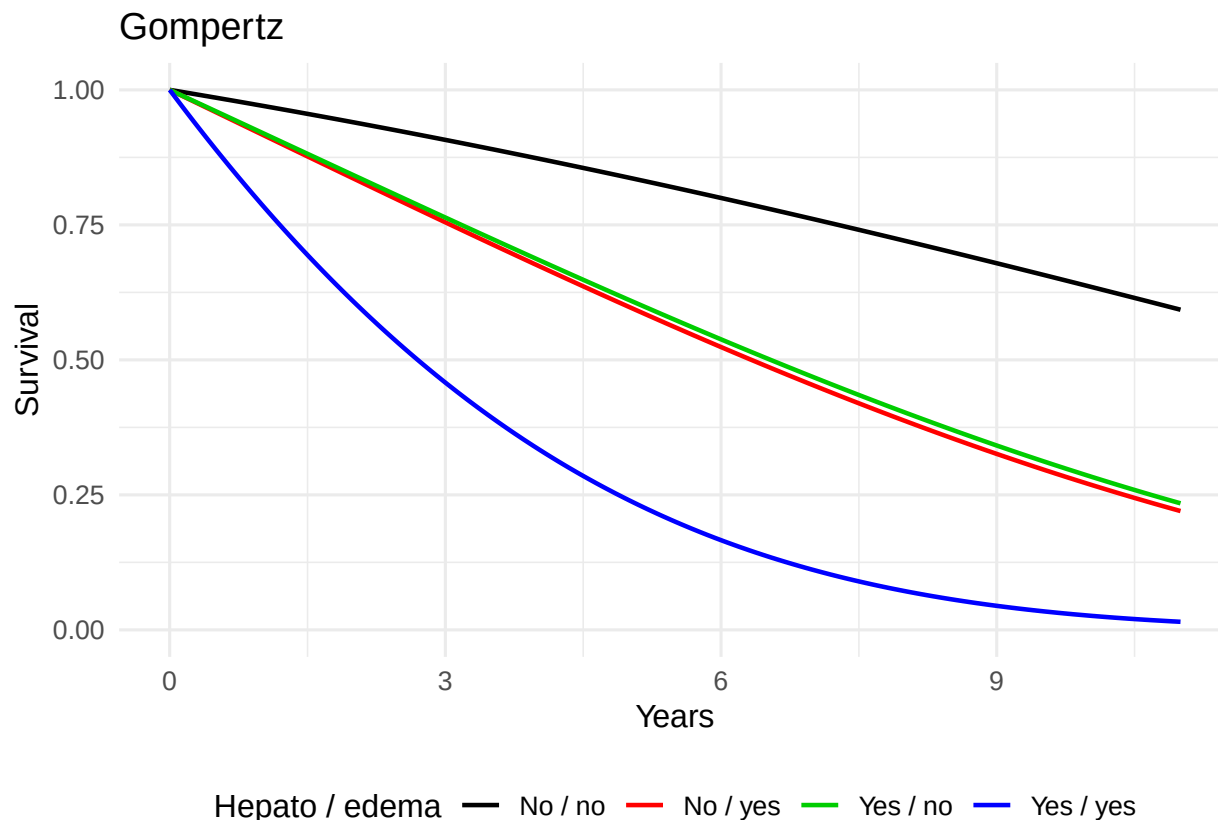
```
plot_he_survival(  
  flexsurv_he_df(fitn), "Log-normal", type = "line"  
)
```



```
plot_he_survival(  
  flexsurv_he_df(fitf), "Generalized F", type = "line"  
)
```

```
plot_he_survival(  
  flexsurv_he_df(fitg), "Gompertz", type = "line"  
)
```



Combined figure

For ease of reference in the text, we also combine six of the survival curve plots above - Cox, stratified Cox, the two additive hazards (OLS) variants, additive hazards (MLE), and semi-parametric AFT - into a single 3x2 figure, panel- labelled (a)-(f) for later reference. The “Hepato / edema” legend (which is identical across all six panels) is collected into a single shared legend rather than repeated six times.

```
# Prepares one panel for the combined figure: imposes the same
# x-axis breaks/range on every panel (some of the six plots
# otherwise pick different default breaks, e.g. 0/4/8/12 instead
# of 0/3/6/9/12, so 12 doesn't line up horizontally across
# panels), and adds the (a)-(f) tag directly inside the panel via
# annotate() at x = Inf, y = -Inf. This anchors the tag to the
# panel's own corner, so the tag-to-border distance is identical
# for every panel regardless of differences in title height or
# axis labels between panels - unlike patchwork's built-in
# plot_annotation(tag_levels = ...)/plot.tag.position, which
# measures position relative to the whole plot (title + axes +
# margins included) and so is not guaranteed to look the same
# distance from the panel border across differently-sized plots.
```

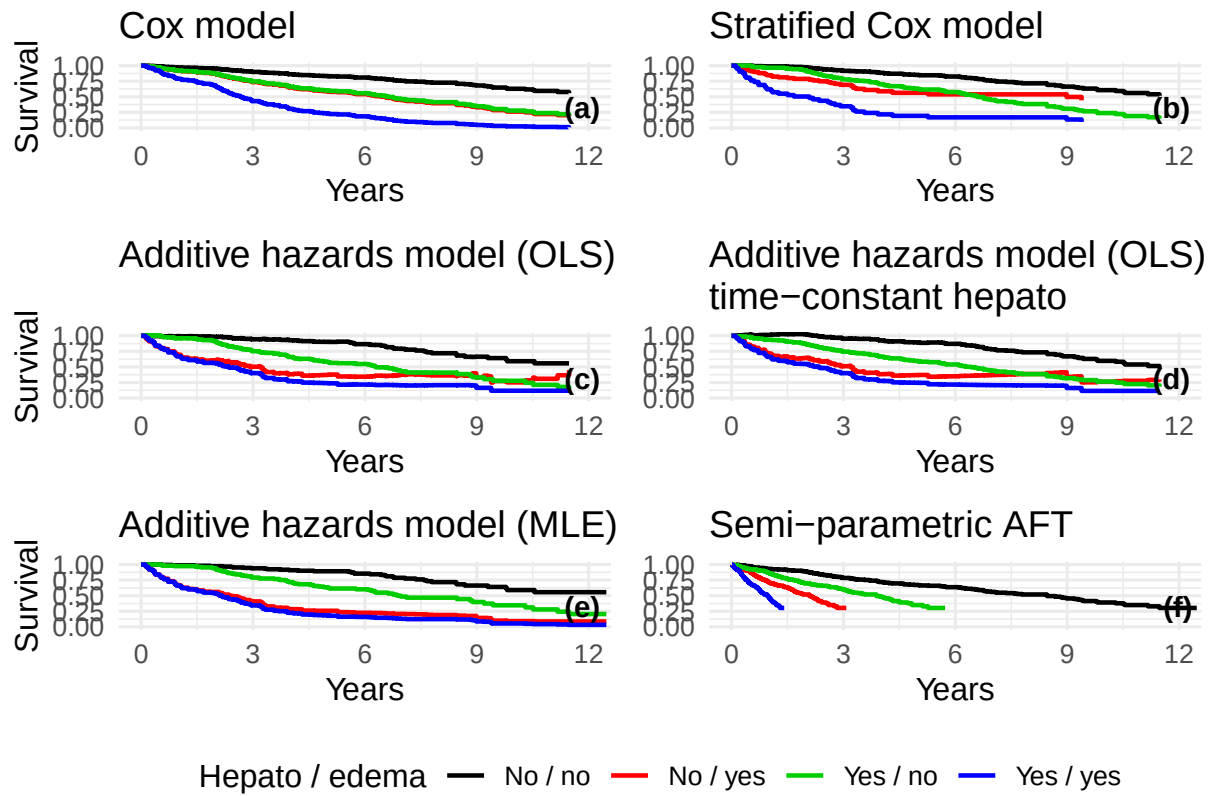
*# show_ylab = FALSE additionally removes the y-axis title, for
the right-hand column of the figure.*

```
tag_panel <- function(p, tag, show_ylab = TRUE) {
  p <- p +
    scale_x_continuous(breaks = seq(0, 12, by = 3)) +
    coord_cartesian(xlim = c(0, 12), ylim = c(0, 1)) +
    annotate(
      "text", x = Inf, y = -Inf, label = tag,
      hjust = 1.3, vjust = -0.6, fontface = "bold"
    )
  if (!show_ylab) p <- p + labs(y = NULL)
  p
}
```

```
combined_fig <-
  (tag_panel(p_cox, "(a)") |
   tag_panel(p_scox, "(b)", show_ylab = FALSE)) /
  (tag_panel(p_ah1, "(c)") |
   tag_panel(p_ah2, "(d)", show_ylab = FALSE)) /
  (tag_panel(p_ah3, "(e)") |
   tag_panel(p_bj, "(f)", show_ylab = FALSE)) +
  plot_layout(guides = "collect")
```

```
## Coordinate system already present. Adding new coordinate system, which will
## replace the existing one.
## Coordinate system already present. Adding new coordinate system, which will
## replace the existing one.
## Coordinate system already present. Adding new coordinate system, which will
## replace the existing one.
## Coordinate system already present. Adding new coordinate system, which will
## replace the existing one.
## Coordinate system already present. Adding new coordinate system, which will
## replace the existing one.
## Coordinate system already present. Adding new coordinate system, which will
## replace the existing one.
```

```
combined_fig <- combined_fig & theme(legend.position = "bottom")
# pdf("Combined_survival_curves.pdf", width = 8, height = 10)
combined_fig
```



```
# dev.off()
```